

Go crazy on the transitions

Unless you're a tacky wedding videographer, please don't use a heart shaped wipe or anything as cheesy. Stick to simple fades and ask yourself if the fancy wipe will add to what you're trying to say before you throw it in. For example, you can use a clock type transition to show the passing of time. Don't use it if you're cutting to another person.



One to another.

Jump

Unless you're Jean Luc Godard please maintain the 180 degree rule-

where an imaginary line runs between the characters on screen and the camera. Please don't have character A on the left of frame, B on the right and cut to close up of A looking left. It's unsettling to put it nicely.

Do it in one go

Take breaks. Trust us, you're make less mistakes and you're spot the ones you've already made better. Splitting your video in to batches and finishing all the work on one batch before moving on to the next will also improve your efficiency. Also make somebody watch the video carefully before you export it.

Photo

If you're the type of photographer who feels that editing the photo is where the true talent of a photographer lies, you are a graphic designer. Not a photographer.

Do's

Stay Raw

Work on RAW, Tiff or DNG. They're range from being uncompressed to negligibly compressed. You have better control over your edits when you work on RAW. Highlights and shadows can be played with to expand your dynamic range and the true potential of noise removal is fathomed among other things.

Be a Miser

Convince yourself that every tool you use on your image brings the world